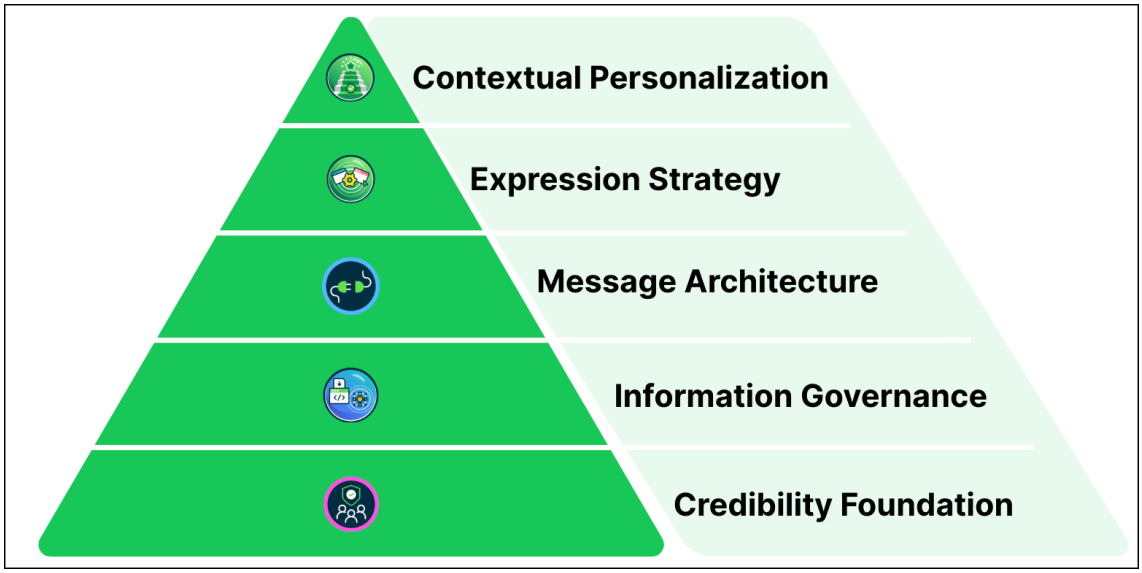
Communication basics

Communication is the exchange of information in a way that ensures the receiver understands the message as intended. To be effective in their role, architects must translate complex information into clear messages and concepts to prevent delays and misalignment.

Pyramid model of communication

The pyramid model of communication is a way of structuring messages, so they are clear, logical, and persuasive.



1. **Credibility foundation**: Trust through reliability and professionalism.
2. **Information governance**: Share the right information with the right people.
3. **Message architecture**: Structure content, audience, and timing.
4. **Expression strategy**: Tone, delivery style, and clarity.
5. **Contextual personalization**: Tailor communication to individual needs

Why Messages Get Misinterpreted

- Different knowledge levels
- Noise from assumptions or distractions
- Lack of feedback

Communicate value: 5 steps

Communicating value is about more than just sharing information. It's about making your message resonate and drive action. Follow these steps to ensure communication delivers impact:

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- **Discover:** Encourage conversations to Identify pain points.
- **Listen & empathize:** Reflect concerns and show you understand.
- **Tailor message**: Map capabilities to needs.
- **Align to objectives**: Link to business outcomes.
- **Quantify:** Share measurable benefits.

Presentation Essentials

Architects are often tasked with explaining intricate systems and solutions to audiences with varying technical backgrounds. Visual tools and effective presentations are essential for transforming complex ideas into clear, accessible messages.

Presentation: Key Dos & Don'ts

Dos	Don'ts
Start with the audience's goal	Overload slides with text
Use visuals	Dive into technical depth too early
Show enthusiasm	Assume shared understanding
Use clear structure	Present without a purpose
Practice thoroughly	Leave next steps unclear
End with a clear action	

Feedback for clarity

Structured feedback is vital for architects and teams to improve performance, resolve misunderstandings, and foster a culture of continuous improvement. Use these proven feedback models to ensure your input is clear, actionable, and focused on positive change.

- **SBI**: Situation → Behavior → Impact
- **CEDAR**: Context → Example → Diagnosis → Action → Review

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